

Subject Code	ENGL3002
Subject Title	Research Methods for Language Studies
Credit Value	3
Level	3
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	None
Objectives	This subject aims to develop students' awareness of the nature of applied language research and provide them with an understanding of language research by familiarising them with different approaches to research design and execution as well as methods of data collection, analysis, presentation, interpretation, and reporting. The subject serves as a preparatory course for undertaking the Capstone Project for Language Studies (ENGL4003) but can also be studied as a stand-alone course for developing research skills.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: Category A: Professional/academic knowledge and skills - demonstrate a sound awareness of the nature of applied language research - understand fundamental concepts and new developments in applied language research - produce a research proposal in an appropriate format - design quantitative, qualitative, and multi-method research - analyse research data manually and with the help of computer programmes (e.g., R) Category B: Attributes for all-roundedness - work critically and creatively - demonstrate analytical and evaluative skills - apply effective strategies for conducting academic research in both independent and team modes
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	- Fundamental concepts of applied language research - Quantitative, qualitative, and multi-method approaches to research - Establishing research problems and questions - Stages of literature review - Research design techniques - Data collection, analysis, triangulation, and interpretation

Effort Expected	▪ Lectures	39 hrs
	▪ Seminars	0 hrs
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Private study	58 hrs
	▪ Quiz and assignments	29 hrs
	Total student study effort	126 hrs
Reading List and References	Brown, J. D. (2001). <i>Using surveys in language programs</i>. Cambridge University Press. Burns, R. B. (2000). <i>Introduction to research methods</i> (4th ed.). SAGE. Creswell, J. W., & Poth, C. N. (2024). <i>Qualitative inquiry and research design: Choosing among five approaches</i> (5th ed.). Sage Publications. Creswell, J. W., & Creswell, J. D. (2022). <i>Research design: Qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods approaches</i> (6th ed.). Sage Publications. Dörnyei, Z. (2007). <i>Research methods in applied linguistics</i>. Oxford University Press. Dörnyei, Z., & Dewaele, J.-M. (2022). <i>Questionnaires in second language research: Construction, administration, and processing</i> (3rd ed.). Routledge. Duff, P. A. (2008). <i>Case study research in applied linguistics</i>. Lawrence Erlbaum Associates. Mackey, A., & Gass, S. M. (2021). <i>Second language research: Methodology and design</i> (3rd ed.). Routledge. Marshall, C., & Rossman, G. B., & Blanco, G. (2021). <i>Designing qualitative research</i> (7th ed.). Sage Publications. McEnery, T., Xiao, R., & Tono, Y. (2006). <i>Corpus-based language studies: An advanced resource book</i>. Routledge. Paltridge, B., & Phakti, A. (Eds.) (2010). <i>Continuum companion to research methods in applied linguistics</i>. Continuum International.	

Revised by Stefano Occhipinti, March 2025